Alexander Reinthal

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reinthal

An independent AI safety researcher with a taste for work at the intersection of interpretability, misuse risks, and model organisms of misalignment. I bring 7 years of industry experience across cyber-security, data, and ML engineering.

Research Projects

Can lying probes flag a Chinese model's deceptive answers? *Jan 2026 – present*
Found that deception probes (Apollo, 2025) are unreliable at detecting questionable answers from Chinese models on politically sensitive questions.

- Extension of ARENA 7.0 weekend hackathon, 1st place. Supported by Bluedot Impact rapid grant.

About Emergent Misalignment *Jan 2026 – present*
Found that emergent misalignment (EM) rate is negatively correlated with the capability benchmarks GSM8K (Pearson −0.98) and MMLU (Pearson −0.94).

- Extension of ARENA 7.0 capstone, 3rd place.

Changing the prompt for instrumental convergence evals *May 2026 – June 2026*
Removing pressure phrases increases misalignment rate for capability prompts (He et al. 2025) but decreases it for propensitity prompts (Hopman et al. 2026) for Gemini 3.1 Pro Preview.

Detecting Piecewise Cyber Espionage in Model APIs *Nov 2025 – Nov 2025*
Proof of concept for detecting malicious activity across multiple agent sessions.

- Research continued through SPAR by David Williams-King (ERA) and Linh Le (Mila). Apart Research sprint, 4th place of 641 submissions.

Experience

AI Safety Researcher *May 2026 – present*
Independent

- Supported by Coefficient Giving's Career Transition grant for reducing global catastrophic risks.

Research mentor *Mar 2026 – present*
Bluedot Impact

- Facilitator and research mentor for the Technical AI Safety course and project.

Alum *Jan 2026 – Feb 2026*
ARENA 7.0

- Five-week intensive curriculum on transformer internals, mechanistic interpretability, RLHF, evals, JAX, and the Inspect framework.

Data Platform Engineer / Tech Lead / Data Scientist *Gothenburg, Sweden*
Knowit Solutions Cocreate *Feb 2022 – present*

- Pioneered LLM evals at the company. Implemented an OAuth-authenticated MCP gateway to secure agentic workflows.

Security Analyst *Gothenburg, Sweden*
NTT Security *Apr 2019 – Jan 2022*

- Deployed ML an classifier that reduced analysis time of malicious domains from 2 hours per shift per analyst to 10 minutes per shift per analyst.

Python Software Engineer *Gothenburg, Sweden*
Ericsson *June 2017 – Oct 2018*

- First job where I led a team building a log-parsing and analytics tool that got funded and grew into a dedicated engineering team.

Publications

Data Modeling for Predicting Software Exploits Nov 2018
Peer-reviewed paper predicting which CVEs become exploited in the wild. Adopted by Recorded Future's Vulnerability Intelligence product.
Reinthal, A., Filippakis, E., Almgren, M.. 10.1007/978-3-030-03638-6_21 (Springer LNCS: Nordic Conference on Secure IT Systems)

Open Source and Personal Projects

Casually Jailbreaking Gemini 2.5 Flash *2026 – 2026*
Jailbroke Gemini 2.5 Flash with a few-shot in-context continuation attack, eliciting harmful recommendations.

Open Source Contributions
github.com/reinthal

- Inspect AI PR #3987 Fixed Gemini Pro 3.1 + OpenRouter + Reasoning issue
- Dagster PR #24188 (ML pipeline orchestration) and DLT Hub PR #594 (ingestion reliability)

Skills

Machine Learning & AI: PyTorch, JAX (learned during ARENA 7.0), Einops, XGBoost, SciKit Learn, Jupyter; LLM evals & observability (Inspect, LangChain, Langfuse, Arize Phoenix); linear probes, SFT, automated red-teaming

Programming Languages: Python, JavaScript, SQL, Rust, C/C++, R, Nix, Terraform

Platforms & Tools: Modal, Runpod, Openweights, Weights & Biases, Spark, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, Azure

Certifications: Bluedot Impact — Technical AI Safety (2026-03); AGI Strategy (2025-10)

Education

Chalmers University of Technology *Gothenburg, Sweden*
MS in Engineering Physics *Sept 2016 – June 2018*

- Master thesis got published and put into production at Recorded Future.
- Switched from computer science undergraduate to engineering physics graduate program and performed better.

Gothenburg University *Gothenburg, Sweden*
BS in Computer Science *Sept 2013 – June 2016*

- Thesis on finding common dense subgraphs using linear programming has 4 citations.